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Peking August 20th

Mr. Lowdis

No. 175

5 Inclosures

Rec'd

Oct 7

—"—

Japanese Embassy in China. The Audience

Nothing new in this.

The Japanese Ambassador seems to have done very well.

T.

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175

Mitre near Peking
20th August 1873

My Lord,

I have the honour to inclose
copy of a despatch from
Sir Harry Parkes acknowledging
one in which I had apprised
him of the reception of
foreign ministers by the
Emperor of China, and
requesting some promise
in formalism regarding the
ceremony, particularly in

The Right Honble
Earl Granville K.G.

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in so far as it concerned
the Japanese Ambassador.
Sir Harry Parkes also
desired to be informed
of the results of the
Ambassador's negotiations
respecting Loo Choo and
Formosa.

I have thought it best
to prepare for him a
summary of the history
of the Japanese disputes,
so far as it is known to
me, from first to last,
and to supply him with
a copy of the Compte
Rendu signed by myself

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and my colleagues as
regarding the particulars
of our reception, prefixing
it with a brief review of the
discussion preceding the
audience.

I have the honor to
inclose copy of my
Confidential despatch to
Sir Harry Parkes giving
cover to these papers.

I have the honor to be,
With the highest respect.
My Lord,
Your Lordships
most obedient humble servant
Thomas Francis Wade.

½

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Sir H. Parkes

&

Mr. Loch

—2—

Inclosure

No. 1

in Mr. Loch's

No. 175

of August 20th 1873

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Copy

Yedo
July 26. 1873

Sir

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your Despatch of the 29th ulto informing me that on that day the Japanese Ambassador and the Foreign Representatives at Peking had been received in audience by the Emperor.

I have much pleasure in congratulating you on the settlement, in so satisfactory a manner

T. F. Wade Esqre C.B
&c &c &c
Peking

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manner, of a state question of such high importance.

I also wish to take this opportunity of mentioning to You that reports emanating from sources which possess weight attach to the Japanese Ambassador a prominent share in bringing about the reception of the Foreign Ministers.

I presume to myself the liberty of questioning the accuracy of these reports until they are more fully authenticated; but as the Japanese Ambassador is the Foreign Minister of Japan and as he has now returned

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returned to Yedo, you will readily appreciate the advantage I should derive, in a public point of view, if I were furnished by you with some information, as to what has really taken place at Peking in regard to the reception of the Japanese Ambassador, and also as to the ceremonial and etiquette adopted by the Emperor in the reception of the Foreign Ministers. I trust that, if this suggestion should appear to you inconvenient, you will be so good as to consider the objects

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object with which this made.

I informed you in a former despatch of the position assumed in Yedo in respect to the Loochoo Islands and I shall feel obliged if you could acquaint me how this question and the one relative to Formosa was treated by the Japanese Ambassador when at Peking.

I have &c

(Signed) Harry S Parkes.

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No. 5

Mr. Lowther
to
Sir H. Parkes

— 2 —

Enclosure
No. 2
in Mr. Lowther's
No. 175
of August 20th 1873.

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No. 175

Peking
Augt. 20. 1873.

y

idential

Sir

I am in receipt of the Desp:
dated July 26, in which you
did me the honor to acknowledge
mine of the 29th of June, apprising
you that foreign Ministers had
been received by the Emperor
of China.

The information you desire
regarding the Audience itself
and the part played by the
Japanese Ambassador in relation
to this and other questions
will be found supplied with

H. Parkes K.C.B.

Have

&c &c &c

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more or less fulness in the two Memoranda appended.

The first is little more than a copy of the complete-rendu signed by the Ministers present, as recording what occurred upon the day of their reception. I have prefixed to this a short notice of the discussion which occupied the four months intervening between the termination of the minority and the conclusion of the Audience.

The second Memorandum, is an account, so far as I am able to furnish one of the proceedings of the Japanese

Mission

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Mission from the time of its
arrival in China up to its
departure from Pekin.

I have
&c &c &c

Signed/ T. Wade.

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Memorandum

—o—

Inclosure
No. 3
in Mr. Lewis
No. 175
of August 20th 1873.

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No 14

Memorandum on the Audience forwarded to Sir H. Parkes.

The termination of the Regency, as about to take place on the 21st. of February, had been announced some days previously by Decree. Upon the 18th. of February, Monsieur de Rehfues, Minister of Germany received a Note from some of the Ministers of the Yamên to the effect that an answer to the letter of Credence

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Credence of his Government;
translation of which he had
handed to the Prince of Kung
on his return from Europe,
in November 1872, had been
prepared by desire of the
Emperor of China and would
be brought him on the Morrow.

Having consulted his
Colleagues, he sent to say that
though he would be happy to
see the Ministers who proposed
to call on him, he must decline
to receive the Letter they had
told him they would bring.

After.

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after a long discussion, it was the same day agreed that as soon as the Emperor's assumption of the Government should be made known to them, namely the Ministers of Russia, America, England and France, should in a Collective Note request permission to present their congratulations to the Emperor in person.

On the day named, the 23rd of February, the Emperor assumed the Government. The Prince of Hsing the same evening announced

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announced the event in a circular to the Legations and on the 22nd the collective note of the foreign Ministers was addressed to the Prince of Kung

The Chinese Govt had been warned by various Ministers and others that with the [illegible] of the Minority, the Kiaochow Question would be certainly revived. This, at any time during the last twelve years but more particularly of late. The Grand Secretary, Li Hung-Chang, who is also Govr-Genl of Chihli, had been spoken

to

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to upon the subject by every
Minister passing through Peiking.
The German Minister had worked
it on his return in November
and had again reminded
the Ministers sent to him
on the 18th of February, the
occasion just referred to, that
they might possibly be called
on to take some decision in the
next few days.

The Yamên was notwithstanding
completely unprepared. The Grand
Secretary Wensiang, who is the
real foreign Minister, immediately

asked

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asked for sick leave. The Prince of Liang left the Collective Note of the 24th of February for about a fortnight unanswered, and then only replied with an invitation to the Ministers who had signed it, to confer with the Grand Secretary and his Colleagues.

The first conference was held at the Russian Legation, Monsieur Vlangaly being Doyen, on the 11th of March, and though little was elicited from the Chinese Ministers

beyond

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beyond a statement of the ceremonial difficulty well-known, to wit, the indispensability of genuflexion and prostration, there lone, on the whole, was not thought unsatisfactory. The Russian Minister then proceeding to Shanghai to meet the Grand Duke Alexis, a second conference was held upon the 12th of March between his Colleagues and the Chinese at the German Legation.

This was by much, less satisfactory than the first. The old objections to modification

of

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of Chinese etiquette were repeated and were reinforced in particular by the argument that Rupia, a power the equal of China, having for two centuries accepted it, the changes proposed would reduce China to the level of a Rupian dependency.

On this, appeal was made to the Prince of Kung but with no immediate effect - at a Conference held at the Yamên on the 21st. of March, His Highness contended that

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that by giving up the Kokuryo China met foreign Powers half-way. The genuflexion was indispensable. No reference to the Throne either could be made until the question of etiquette had been settled.

After some negotiation, however, it was promised, that the request of foreign Ministers should be laid before the Emperor as soon as His Majesty returned from the Tombs to which he was to proceed with a full court upon the 1st of April.

A delay of some three weeks

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works ensued, and the German Minister having determined to leave Peking before the Summer heats commenced, Mrs departed for Europe - The Russian Minister, however, almost at the same moment arrived from Shanghai and a Decree having been issued by which the Yamên was directed to consider the question of etiquette with foreign Ministers, the discussion was resumed and continued up to the 15th of May when the Protocol appended was signed as representing the arguments advanced on either side.

Ah

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At one Conference it had been plainly stated by the foreign Ministers that any farther allusion to the genuflection would be offensive. The Chinese could not concede more than a promise that the Emperor should be prayed to decide, and the Protocol, it was understood, was to be related in volume and it's contents being summarised in a paper which was to be communicated to foreign Ministers, the Yamên's Memorial was to be based upon it.

The

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The new paper being presently communicated to foreign Ministers was found to differ no little from the Protocol and this occasioned a farther correspondence which naturally postponed the presentation of the Yamên's memorial.

At Last, on the 14th of June, the Decree appeared in the Gazette. The Prince of Kung forwarded copy of it the following day to the foreign Ministers who were at the same time invited to meet the Ministers

of

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of the Yamên upon the 16th
The Decree appearing to
foreign Ministers in more respects
than one open to objection, a
sharp debate ensued. The
Decree represented foreign
Ministers as having "humbly
besought" the Audience; the
letters of their Governments
were mentioned without the
honor clerically due to them
as coming from the equals of the
Emperor,
the Ministers themselves were
hardly distinguished if at all
from the Envoys of States
dependent on China.
All these points were
attacked and angrily defended.
But

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but the Decree was of course
past reeal.

In the programme of
etiquette much that was wrongly
accepted was at first objected
to; but on one point foreign
Ministers stood firm, and
an important compromise was
effected. It was at first proposed
that the Letters of Credence should
be laid on a table in the
Hall of Reception. The Minister
Paoyün was to take them up
and hand them to the Prince
of Kung, who, upon his knees
of course, was to present them
to the Emperor. It was, after
some

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some delays of discussion it was agreed that the table should be moved nearer to the Throne, that the Letters should be laid upon it and that the Emperor should himself make some sign in acknowledgement of their reception -

For the rest the Audience took place under the conditions recorded in the Memorandum which follows these prefatory observations. To what extent they were affected by the Japanese Ambassador's action will appear in the Memorandum devoted to the history of his Mission

I am Sir Wade

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Memorandum

Enclosure
No 4
in Mr. Bodisco
No 175
of August 20th 1873.

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97

Memorandum of the Reception of Foreign Ministers by the Emperor of China 29th June 1873.

opy.

The Foreign Ministers provided with Letters of Credence having accepted the Programme communicated to them by the Yamên on the 25th June it was agreed that each should proceed from his own residence on the morning of the 29th to the Roman Catholic Establishment — known as the Pei-Tang, where the Bishop Monseigneur Delaplace, had been so good as to provide accommodation for those who might wish to change their dress. The rendez-vous was to be at a quarter before Six A.M. at which time the Minister Chung-Hoow was to meet the Foreign Ministers at

the

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the Pei. Yang, for the purpose of conducting them to the gate by which they were to enter the Palace Grounds.

On his arrival the different Ministers, each in his chair, and, if he had a foreign escort attended by his escort, proceeded towards the Marble Bridge which spans the Pei. Hai, the lake in the Palace Grounds. The bridge is, on ordinary days, a thoroughfare, but, by the Emperor's desire, a barricade had been thrown across the Western end of it. This, with a corresponding barricade a little farther to the West, marked off a space right and left of the Yu. Hua. Mên, the gate by which the Ministers were to be admitted into the Palace Grounds, in such wise that room was left for the chairs of the Ministers and for their escort.

Within the gate there were

waiting

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waiting the Grand Secretary Wên-Siang, and all the other Ministers of the Tsung-li Yamên with the exception of the Presidents Pao-Yün and Shen-Kwei-fên, who, as it had been intimated upon the 26th June they would be, were with the Prince of Kung in attendance upon the Emperor.

The Grand Secretary and his colleagues conducted the Foreign Ministers to the Shih-Ying-Kung, where they found the Japanese Ambassador Soyesima Tanomi, who had come from his residence in another part of the town. The Japanese Ambassador was accompanied by his Interpeter. The Envoys Extraordinary and Ministers Plenipotentiary of Russia, the United States, Great Britain and France, and the Diplomatic Agent of the Netherlands, were accompanied

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accompanied by M. Bismarck, Secrétaire - Interprète of the German Legation, as Interpreter to the Corps Diplomatique. M. Devéria, First Interpreter of the French Legation, accompanied his Minister, who, it had been arranged, was to have a second Audience for the purpose of delivering the reply of the French Government to the Letter of explanations carried to France by the Minister Chung-How in 1870, after the massacre of Tientsin.

The Shih-Ying-Kung, or Palace of Due Season, is a temple in which prayers are offered by the Emperor for rain or for fair weather, as the case may require. In rear of it are some apartments in which, when about to sacrifice, the Emperor robes and unrobes. Here there were some refreshments from the Imperial Buttery, set out upon two tables. The Foreign

Ministers

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Ministers seated themselves at these and, after waiting about an hour and a half, were invited to move onward to a large tent pitched on the West side of the Tzŭ-Kwang-Ko, or Purple Pavilion the building in which the Emperor had decided to give Audience.

The Prince of Kung with the Ministers Pao and Shên met the Foreign Ministers outside this tent in which it had been understood they would have to wait a short time before they were summoned to the Presence. The interval here, however, as already in the Shih-Ying-Kung, proved much longer than had been expected. The Prince and his colleagues explained that the Emperor had received important Despatches from the seat of war in the North-West, and that these had detained His Majesty. His Highness and his colleagues

went

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went and came, apologizing from time to time for the delay. Thus about another hour and a half passed away.

At last a little after nine o'clock, the Japanese Ambassador and his Interpreter were ushered into the Pavilion by some of the Ministers of the Yamên. They returned in a few minutes, and the Representatives of Western Powers were then called for.

Turning to the left as they quitted the tent, the Ministers of the Yamên conducted them up a low flight of stone steps on the Western face of a large platform lying to the South or in front of the Pavilion, and, crossing the angle of this platform, they entered the Pavilion, as it had been agreed they should,

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should, by the space between the first and second columns, to the West of the centre division of the Pavilion. General Rangaly Minister of Russia led the way as Doyen of the Corps Diplomatique, and was followed, in the order of their seniority, by Mr. Low, — Mr. Wade, M. de Geofroy, and Mr. Ferguson, respectively representing the Governments of the United States, Great Britain, France, and the Netherlands.

The interior of the Pavilion is divided by wooden pillars into five sections running from North to South. The Emperor was seated on a Throne at the — Northernmost end of the centre section. The Throne itself stood on a dais or platform raised three or four feet above the floor of the hall, access being gained

to

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to it by three small flights of steps one in the centre and the other two right and left of the Throne. A light balustrade, broken of course by these three flights of steps ran round the wooden platform. Half way down the Hall, at some ten or twelve paces from the Throne, and directly opposite to it, stood a long narrow table, — covered with yellow.

Beside the Throne stood a few Princes of the highest order. On the Emperor's left stood the Prince of Kung, the Prince of Chun (known to foreigners as the seventh Prince) and the Prince of P'o, son of the famous Sêngolinsin; on the right the Prince of Li and another. On either side of the Hall, in double rank, were ranged officials — apparently of the first rank. They were placed so that the

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inner flanks of their lines touched the platform below the Throne, near its outer angles; the reverse flanks extending outwards till they reached the limits of the centre division of the Hall. In rear of them, on either side of the Throne, were other officials in groups without arrangement.

The Foreign Ministers, having filed across the Hall, as they came in front of the Throne, bowed to the Emperor, then advanced a few paces and bowed again, and finally halting in front of the yellow table, bowed a third time. M. Bismarck, who had followed the Ministers in his capacity of Interpreter, took his place in rear of the Doyen. The Grand Secretary, probably, as the officer charged with the introduction of Ministers, took post slightly in advance of

their

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their line, at the same time somewhat to the left of it.

The Doyen then read the address appended to this Memo, M. Bismarck read a Chinese translation of it, and, the reading ended, Foreign Ministers laid their Letters of Credence upon the yellow table, bowing once as before.

As the Letters were laid upon the table, the Emperor bent slightly forward, as in acknowledgment of their reception and the Prince of Kung falling on his knees, was commanded by His Majesty, in a low voice, to inform Foreign Ministers that their Letters had been received. The Prince rose, descended the steps, and advancing a short distance towards the Ministers, repeated what had been said to him.

His Highness then reascended the platform, and again falling on his knees, was again addressed by

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by the Emperor. On rising he again came down the steps, and coming up this time to the Doyen, he said that his Majesty trusted that the Emperor, Kings and Presidents of the States represented were in good health, and hoped that all Foreign affairs would be satisfactorily arranged between the Tsung-li Yamên and Foreign Ministers.

This ended the general audience. The French Minister, M. de Geofroy, having, as above mentioned, a second letter to deliver from his Government, — remained; his interpreter, M. Devéria being introduced as the rest of the Ministers withdrew. This they did "à reculons" and bowing as is usual in other countries.

The whole party, the Japanese Ambassador included, was in a few minutes reassembled in the Shih-Ying-Kung, and after staying there a short time, they

were

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were conducted to their chairs by the Ministers of the Yamên present, the Grand Secretary joining his colleagues as they approached the gate.

Signed { A. Wangaly
Frederick F. Low
Thomas Francis Wade
L. de Geofroy
J. H. Ferguson

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Memorandum

Enclosure
No. 5
in Mr. Lowdis
No. 175
of August 20th 1873

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Copy

Memorandum on the Japanese Mission — 1873.

The Ambassador Soyeshima Tanéomi arrived in Peking about the beginning of May. He had paused some time in Shanghai en route, and a rumour had preceded him that he was about to settle various questions, the pending Audience included, with a very high hand.

This was probably due to the language held by Monsieur Le Gendre, a naturalised American of French origin who was attached to the Japanese Embassy

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Embassy with Japanese rank
of the Second Degree. Whether he
had a commision from the
Govt. of Japan I have been unable
to ascertain, I doubt it. He
had been Consul General for the
United States at Amoy and
had in that capacity visited
Formosa, where he succeeded in
arranging with the Aborigines
certain conditions for the protection
of Seamen shipwrecked on their
Coasts. His activity in Formosa
as well as at Amoy and Foochow
had made him somewhat obnoxious

to

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to the Chinese authorities. He had however completed his Consular Service in China when the Japanese Embassy was about to start, and was in Japan, it is said on his way to take up a post to which he had been named in South America, when, at the instance of the United States' Legation he was enlisted by the Japanese. His acquaintance with Komura may have had something to say to his appointment, but he was more probably retained simply as a Secretary of

Correspondence

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in French and English. He gave out also as that he purposely kept aloof from negotiations with the Chinese. In effect, he was only present at one interview between the Chinese and his Ambassador, and in matters discussed between them he did not appear to be consulted.

In the Ambassador's relations with the Ministers of Western Powers he was consulted, and it was probably due to his advice, that Loyesima was induced to expect that all foreign representatives would

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would immediately call upon him. It was explained to him through Monsieur Legendre that until after his reception by the Emperor he would not be entitled to this honor and Soyesima had the sense to perceive that he would gain rather than lose by making the acquaintance of the Ministers in residence. Either of himself or upon information given him, however, Monsieur Legendre gave him to understand that some of them would have paid him

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him the first visit had it not
been for the opposition of the
rest. This was the reverse of
the truth.

His acquaintance once
made, his new colleagues had
every reason to be satisfied
with Soyesima. He was not
pretentious, and though apparently
watchful lest anything short of
his due should be tendered him,
never exacting. He shewed none
of the disposition to patronize
which, with the Chinese, is so
commonly the return made for
foreign politeness; nothing moreover

in

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in brief discussions of the
peculiarity and circumlocution
of the Chinese, as a rule he
came straight to the point, and
only on one occasion did I
perceive a tendency to that
affectation of high moral grounds
which is so wearisome in
negotiation with Chinese.

The objects of his mission
appear to be as follows: He
had to exchange ratifications
of our Treaty; to deliver a Letter
of congratulation from the
Mikado to the Emperor of China
and to obtain certain
declarations regarding the
jurisdiction

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jurisdiction of China over the people of Formosa and Corea, that might justify action in either country whenever it suited the Japanese to act.

Soyeshima may be said to have fairly accomplished as much as he proposed. About the Treaty he had no difficulties. It has not been made public in China, but it is believed that the modification of one article having been agreed to, the ratification was conceded by the Chinese as a matter of course. The

Grand

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The Grand Secretary Li Hung-Ch'ang, Governor. general of Chih-Li would seem to have behaved with becoming courtesy, although there were rumours of questions sarcastically put by him, regarding the changes, formal and substantial, so recently adopted by Japan. The Governor. General had been for some months previously engaged in arming the Pa. ku forts with Krupp's guns. He had also assembled a considerable force of the troops, whom he has so long commanded. During the stay

of

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of the Japanese, he made great
parade of military preparation
it is believed to their address
for though some apprehended
a formidable resistance on
the part of the Chinese to the
demand for an Audience
made in February, there was
a general abstinence on the
part of other Powers, from
any display that might
have been taken to
menace hostility

In any case the
Japanese were little affected
by it. The Ambassador

Soyeshima

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took from the first a high tone, and although in the matter of etiquette he did not carry all before him, he had fairly the best of it in the discussion of essentials. He stood out at first for a visit to the Prince of Kung, which as might have been expected, His Highness declined to pay until Soyeshima should have prevented himself at the Yamén. Several days were continued in the usual fashion while the Question of the visit was under Debate, but the Japanese Secretaries engaged the Ministers

of

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of the Yamen upon the Loo-choo
Question and the Chinese were
made to understand that
Japan admitted no right on
their part to jurisdiction over
Loo-choo. The Loochooans consider
Soyesima were originally
Japanese. Relations with them
had been partially interrupted
by the revolution of 1602; but
they had been and were the
subjects of Japan. This was the
position taken by Soyesima
in speaking of the matter to
foreign Ministers and there
is reason to believe that
the

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the Chinese were obliged to accept it.

On the other hand, the Chinese were obliged to admit that Formosa, though belonging to China was but partly under their control and that they could not guarantee the safety of Loochoo or any one else who might fall into the hands of the savages on the East coast.

It had been reported that China had paid or would pay an indemnity to Japan for the Loo-choo-ans murdered some time since by these people.

Sagesima

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Soyesima apeared me that none had been paid, and he more than hinted that as the Chinese had been told, Japan would very shortly send a force to bring these savages to reason: which force from the nature of the country would have to be landed in and marched thro'ough the districts officered by the Chinese Gov^t. on the West.

In my last conversation with him, he plainly intended me to believe that this invasion, which can only end in the annexation of Formosa would Formosa

very

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very shortly take place, and on this particular occasion he talked a little cautiously, remarking with a certain show of outraged feeling, that the poor Aborigines of Formosa had been harshly and tyrannically treated by the Chinese. To one of my colleagues he had earlier observed that were the island Japanese, it would at once be thrown open to foreign Trade and he seemed to me in one instance to be endeavouring to draw from me some admission that its annexation would not be unsatisfactory to us. I had been

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been urging him it is true
to speak out on the ground
that British interests were
sufficiently engaged to justify
my desire to know what
was about to happen..

In respect of Corea the
Chinese admitted that that
kingdom, though a tributary
of China was perfectly independent
and that China had no
right of interference either
for or against it. Judging
from what fell from Soyesima
in various conversations, I
inferred that Japan contemplated
hostilities with Corea, but that
Formosa

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Formosa has earlier claims upon her attention. The Rupian would view invasion of Corea with jealousy, and without being able to cite any words specially authorising the conclusion, I believe that during the late mission, Rupian influence was employed to discourage the idea of such an enterprise.

On one point the Chinese and Japanese were agreed: viz- the detection of the "Maria Luz" by the Japanese Government. But in the discussion of this again another humiliating admission was extracted from the Chinese. They allowed that the roof of all evil in the Coolie

Trade

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Trade is the barracoon system
at Macao, but although declining
altogether to recognise the right
of the Portuguese to territorial
jurisdiction in Macao, they
confessed themselves utterly
powerless to restrain the
Portuguese from prosecution of
the Coolie traffic

To return for a moment
to Formosa: since Soyesima's
departure it has been
rumored that the Chinese
are organising a force for
the subjugation of the
aborigines; in other words
for the maintenance of Chinese
Power

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Power in Formosa against all comers. This requires confirmation. The forts of Pa ku and the neighbourhood of Tientsin have been placed in a state of defence that would render it difficult for any Power to take the capital by the throat, but much of all this is due to the personal energy of Li Hung Ch'ang and to his love of playing at war. It is doubtful whether any other Chinese could wield the motley force in great part Ex. rebel, with which he supports his authority, - and were he withdrawn to-morrow the whole

would

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would fall to pieces. As to naval force, although Chinese Gun-boats are multiplying with native crews and commanders they are not fit as yet to be trusted out of sight of land. In a word, I cannot conceive that if the Japanese are det upon annexing Formosa it is in the Power of the Chinese to prevent it.

The influence of the Japanese Ambassador in soothing the Audience difficulty has been exaggerated. The Chinese had perfectly made up their minds

in

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in the first week that the
Collective Note of the 8th. of Febᵉʳʸ
could not be met with a refusal
and the powerpathers which had
consecrated the months of March
and April were purely pro formâ.
Ground so long disputed could
not be surrendered without
the appearance of a fight
Soyesima's arrival occasioned
for the moment fresh delay. It
was not known whether he
would be apigned or (would) accept, a
place with or below the Ministers
of Western Powers; an audience
on the same or on different terms.
Still in the end he undoubtedly

hastened

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hastened the solution which, although the Chinese had been all along prepared to concede, they were not indisposed to postpone.

The questions alluded to above had in effect been disposed of in the first month of his stay, but up to the beginning of June, Soyesima had received no intimation that his Mission as Ambapador had been recognised. I inclose in original two Despatches from Hiogo to the Yamen.

From the first of these it will be seen that the Yamên

through

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though admitting the refusal of other foreign Ministers to perform the Chinese ceremonial and the promise that had been given them to refer the matter to the Emperor, still went through the form of inviting the Japanese to abide by it and that the Japanese referred them to their own literature for precedents of intercourse upon equal terms. In the second he hints at the possibility of a rupture.

I cannot doubt that his correspondence and his tone fastened the appearance

of

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of the 14th of June. His immediate acceptance of this paper, on the other hand, without comment embarrassed his Western Colleagues who in a Conference held at the Yamên on the 16th. of June protested against its language

In the matter of etiquette again - He neither insisted on the presence of his Secretaries nor did he object to admission into the Imperial Presence by the side stairs of the Pavilion neither did he contest certain other minor conditions which to other Ministers appeared objectionable -

But

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But he did make a vigorous fight for reception by the Emperor standing and although he did not carry this point, (his colleagues of Europe and America had earlier declared their indifference on the subject) he contributed a good deal to the termination of the squabble about costume and other details which bid fair at the last to prolong discussion indefinitely. The reputation of Japanese swords was for something in the last act of hesitation, but the watchful pride of the Chinese was alarmed by

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by suggestions from other forces
that if the Court preferred it, all
Representatives alike would
appear out of uniform.

Soyesima's demand to
be received by the Emperor
standing had been responded
to very rudely at the Yamên.
The Grand Secretary Wensiang
completely lost his temper.
Soyesima let it be known
that he was preparing to
leave Peking by a certain
day and the Grand Secretary
immediately losing heart.
made an effort to draw him
to another interview at the
Yamên

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Yamên. This Soyesima declined pleading ill health. but he sent his Secretaries. The result was a visit from Wensiang and his Colleagues and full acknowledgement of his Ambapadorial rank. Soyesima then consulted to be received on whatever terms other foreign Ministers might accept. They had all agreed that as Ambapador he should have a separate Audience to precede their Con.

To conclude, I believe, that thinking he was able and willing to make war, the Chinese were

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were thoroughly frightened by Soyeshima, but I do not feel sure that they would not have found means to put off his reception by the Emperor had the Audience not been already demanded by the Ministers of Western Powers. It is perfectly probable that had they not demanded it, no demand would have been made by the Japanese. On the other hand, although as I have stated the attitude assumed

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apumed by the Japanese did hurry the slowness of the Chinese at the last, I cannot admit the preponderating influence apeigned to him by the Local Press and especially in a long communiqué published in the North China Daily Press, which most likely proceeds from the pen of Monsieur Legendre.

Signed) T. Wade.